

77. The ancient name “Nilotpala” for Mahanadi was stated in
 (a) Matsya Puran (b) Markandey Puran
 (c) Brahm Puran (d) Vayu Puran
 (e) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

The ancient name Nilotpala for Mahanadi was stated in Vayu Purana.

78. 'Manusmriti' is mainly related to –
 (a) Social System (b) Law
 (c) Economics (d) Working method of State

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2007

Ans. (a)

Manusmriti is also known as Manav Dharam Shastra, and is mainly related to the social system. This is one of the 18 major Smriti. It is presumed that the actual human author of this compilation used the eponym 'Manu', which has led the text to be associated by Hindus with the first human being and the first king in the Indian tradition. Manu is also considered to be the originator of law in India.

79. The great law-giver of ancient times was –
 (a) Ashoka (b) Arya Bhatta
 (c) Manu (d) Vatsyayan

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

80. Who among the following is considered to be the first law-giver of India ?
 (a) Panini (b) Manu
 (c) Kautilya (d) Kapil

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

81. Whose composition is 'Natyashastra'?
 (a) Vishwanath (b) Bhamah
 (c) Bharatamuni (d) Bhavabhuti

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

The 'Natyashastra' was written by Bharatmuni. It is an ancient Indian treatise on performing arts, covering drama, dance and music.

82. “Zero” was discovered by –
 (a) Aryabhatta (b) Varahmihira
 (c) Bhaskara-I (d) An anonymous Indian

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

'Zero' was discovered by an anonymous Indian in second century B.C. Arabians learned it from India and spread it over Europe. It was found that the Arabs first used zero in 873 A.D.

83. Zero was invented by –

- (a) Romans (b) Chinese
 (c) Indians (d) Sumerians

U.P. Lower Sub. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

84. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

- (a) Life of Hiuen Tsang - Hui-li
 (b) The Natural History - Ptolemy
 (c) Historial Philippical - Pompeius Trogus
 (d) The Histories - Herodotus

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2015

Ans. (b)

“The Natural History” is the creation of ‘Pliny the Elder,’ a Roman author. Therefore, pair given in option (b) is not correctly matched.

85. The most ancient musical instrument in given options is–

- (a) Sitar (b) Veena
 (c) Sarod (d) Tabla

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (b)

Veena is the most ancient musical instrument in the given options. It has been a part of Indian culture and music since ancient times whereas Sitar, Sarod and Tabla are musical instruments introduced in medieval era.

Pre-Medieval Period

*Ruler of Ajmer, Prithviraj-III, was commonly known as Prithviraj Chauhan. He defeated Muhammad Ghori in 1st battle of Tarain in 1191 AD but suffered defeat in the 2nd battle of Tarain in 1192 AD. *Hammir Epic describes “Chauhans” as Suryavanshi. According to Hammir Epic, Chauhans were the scions of “Chahman”, the son of Sun. They were one of the four fire clans. Vasudeva and Guvak are mentioned as initial kings of this dynasty. *Sharangdev wrote Hammir Raso. Anangpal Tomar Rajput (Tomar dynasty) originally feudatories of the Gurjar- Pratiharas, founded the city of Dhillika (modern Delhi) in 736 AD. **Gopala** was the founder of ‘Pala Dynasty’. He built a monastery in Nalanda. **Dharamapala** was an enthusiastic Buddhist. He was called “**Paramsaugat**” in his inscriptions. He constructed famous Buddhist monasteries at Vikramshila and Somapuri (Paharapur). ***Vikramshila University** was demolished by Bakhtiyar Khalji. The Pala king Devapala was Buddhist. He was also known as “**Param Saugat**” as per the texts. He donated five villages on the request of Java king Balputradev of Sailendra Dynasty for developing a Buddhist Vihar in Nalanda.

*Queen of Govind Chandra Gahadavala, Kumaradevi was Buddhist. She constructed Dharmachakra Jain Vihar in Samath. Krityakalpataru was written by Lakshmidhar minister of Govind Chandra. Last ruler of Gahadavala dynasty was **Jayachandra**.

***Alha and Udal** were related to Mahoba. They were commandants of Chandel king **Parmardidev** (1165-1203 A.D.) who died during the battle with Prithviraj Chauhan. Description of Chandel and Chauhan's terrific struggle is provided in "**Prithviraj Raso**" by Chand Bardai and "**Alhakhand**" of **Parmal Raso** by Jagnik.

***Jejakabhukti** was the ancient name of Bundelkhand. This region was named after Jay Shakti or Jeja/Jejak, grandson of Nannuk (founder of Chandel dynasty). ***Dhangadev**, also known as **Dhanga**, was a king of the Chandel dynasty of Jejakabhukti. Vidyadhara built Kandariya Mahadev temple. Dhanga attained Moksha by abandoning his body in the waters of Ganga and Yamuna at Sangama, Prayagraj.

*Pundravardhana Bhukti was located in the region of North Bengal in ancient times. Its territory was expanded to the northern Bihar during the era of Pala, Chandra and Sena dynasties.

*Nagbhatta I (730-756 A.D.) is considered the founder of Gurjara-Pratihara dynasty, but the actual founder of this dynasty was Vastisara. *Mihirbhoja was the most prominent ruler of Pratihara Dynasty. The capital of Pratiharas was Kannauj. The real founder of Paramara dynasty was Siyak - II and the capital of Paramaras was Dhara. *Chalukyas belonged to Agni Clan lineage, founded by Mularaja - I. The capital of Solankis was Anhilwada. Kannauj is an ancient city whose ancient name was Mahodaya Shri and Kanyakubja during the regime of Mihirbhoj.

*An eminent Jain scholar Hemchandra gained fame during the period of Solanki king Jaysimha Siddharaj (1093-1143 AD). However, he adorned the court of his successor Kumarapala (1143 A.D. -1172 A.D.) as an advisor.

***Lakshmanasena** (1178 A.D. - 1206 A.D.) was the king of Sena Dynasty; he reigned for 28 years. He initiated a new Samvat called 'Lakshmana Samvat'.

*The famous jurists of early medieval India were Hemadri, Vigyaneshwar and Jimutavahana. Vigyaneshwara wrote "Mitakshara", and Jimutavahana wrote "Dayabhaga."

***Rajashekhara** was a courtier scholar of Gurjar-Pratihara king Mahendrapala - I and his son Mahipala I. He compiled texts like **Karpuramanjari**, **Kavyamimamsa**, **Viddhasalabhanjika**, **Bal Ramayana**, **Bhuvankosh**, etc.

***Motupalli** was a very important seaport in the **Kakatiya kingdom**. This seaport is presently located in the Prakasham district of Andhra Pradesh. This port was visited by Italian traveller **Marco Polo**. The Motupalli epigraph specifies the rates assessed on a variety of items, including scents such as sandal, camphor, rose-water, ivory, pearls, corals, a range of metals like copper, zinc and lead; silk, pepper and areca nuts. It gives an idea of exports and imports from Motupalli port.

*Paramara dynasty was founded in the 9th century A.D. by a person named Upendra or Krishnaraj. A city named Dhara was the capital of Paramara dynasty. *King Bhoj was a Paramara ruler. The early power centre of Paramaras was Ujjain. After the death of King Bhoj, scholars said—

"Adya Dhara Nira Dhara, Niralamba Saraswati, Pandita Khandita sarve Bhoj Raje Divangate".

*The popular book 'Samarangana Sutradhara' written by Paramara king Bhoj was based on architecture and artificial scientific equipment. 'Saraswati Kanthabharan', 'Siddhanta Sangraha', 'Yoga Sutra vritti', 'Rajamartand', 'Yukti-Kalpataru' and 'Charucharya' are some of his masterpieces.

***Bhojshala temple** is located in Dhar district of Madhya Pradesh and was established by Paramara King Bhoj in 1035 A.D. as a Sanskrit school. The presiding deity of Bhojshala temple is Goddess Saraswati. Now, Bhojshala is situated in the premises of Kamal Maula Mosque.

***Gangeyadev** was a ruler of the **Kalachuri dynasty**. He adopted the title of Vikramaditya. He started issuing gold coins after their extinction in pre-medieval period.

1. Who among the following rules is famous as "Prithvi Raj Chauhan"?

- (a) Prithviraja- I (b) Prithviraja- II
(c) Prithviraja- III (d) None of the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

Ruler of Ajmer, Prithviraja-III, commonly known as Prithviraj Chauhan, defeated Muhammad Ghori in the first battle of Tarain in 1191 AD but faced defeat in the second battle of Tarain, in 1192 AD.

2. The brave Chauhan ruler of Ajmer who conquered Delhi and annexed it into his kingdom was –

- (a) Vigraharaj IV (b) Arnoraj
(c) Ajayaraj (d) Prithviraj III
(e) Question not attempted

Raj. P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

Vigraharaj IV was the most powerful ruler of the Chauhan dynasty. He conquered the nearby region and increased the boundaries of the empire. He triumphed over the Tomaras and took possession of Eastern Punjab and Delhi. He won over the Muslim ruler of Punjab.

3. Epigraphic records (Inscriptions) suggest that in ancient India, the rulers of Bihar had contact with –

- (a) Burma (b) Thailand
(c) Cambodia (d) Java-Sumatra

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

The Pala king Devapala was Buddhist. He was also known as "Param Saugat" as per the texts. He donated five villages at the request of Java king Balputradev of Sailendra Dynasty for developing a Buddhist Vihar in Nalanda.

4. The ruler of Suvarnabhumi, who founded a Buddhist monastery at Nalanda and requested Devapala through his ambassador to grant five villages for its maintenance, was

(a) Dharanindra
(b) Sangramadhyananjaya
(c) Balaputradeva
(d) Chudamanivarmana
(e) None of the above/more than one of the above.

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre)-2018

Ans. (c)

Balaputradeva was the ruler of Suvarnabhumi, who founded a Buddhist monastery at Nalanda and requested Devapala to grant five villages for its maintenance.

5. Kumaradevi, a queen of Govind Chandra Gahadavala, constructed Dharma-Chakra-Jaina Vihara at –

(a) Bodh Gaya (b) Rajgriha
(c) Kushinagar (d) Sarnath

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007

Ans. (d)

Queen of Govind Chandra Gahadavala, Kumaradevi was Buddhist. She constructed Dharma Chakra Jain Vihar in Sarnath. So, option (d) is the correct answer.

6. According to Hammir Mahakavya the Chauhans were:

(a) Chandravanshi (b) Brahmins
(c) Yaduvanshis (d) Suryavanshis

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

Hammir Epic reports "Chauhans" as Suryavanshi. According to Hammir epic, Chauhans were the scions of "Chahman", the son of Sun. They were one of the four fire clans.

7. Alha-Udal were related to –

(a) Chanderi (b) Vidisha
(c) Mahoba (d) Panna

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

Alha and Udal belonged to Mahoba. They were commandants of Chandel King Parmardidev (Parmal) (1165-1203 CE), who died during the battle with Prithviraj Chauhan. Description of Chandel and Chauhan's terrific struggle is provided in "Prithviraj Raso" by Chand Bardai and "Alha-Khand" of "Parmal Raso" by Jagnik. So option (c) is the correct answer.

8. Who is the author of 'Alhakhand'?

(a) Chand Bardai (b) Rajasekhara
(c) Parmardidev (d) Jagnik

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2025

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

9. The author of 'Prithviraj Raso' is –

(a) Kalhana (b) Bilhana
(c) Jayanaka (d) Chand Bardai

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

10. Who is the author of 'Prithviraja Vijaya'?

(a) Chand Bardai
(b) Prithviraja Chauhan
(c) Jayanaka
(d) Nayanchand Suri

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

The author of "Prithviraja Vijaya" is Jayanak.

11. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

(a) Abdur Rehman - Hammir Raso
(b) Chand Bardai - Prithvi Raj Raso
(c) Jagnik - Alha-Khand
(d) Narpati Nalh - Visal Dev Raso

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (a)

Sharangdev wrote Hammir Raso. Other options are correctly matched.

12. Which of the following Rajput dynasties founded the city of Dhillika (Delhi) in the eighth century?

(a) Parmara dynasty (b) Solanki dynasty
(c) Tomar dynasty (d) Chauhan dynasty

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

Anangpal Tomar Rajput (Tomar dynasty), originally feudatories of the Gurjar-Pratihars, founded the city of Dhillika (modern Delhi).

13. Jejakabhukti was the ancient name of –

(a) Baghelkhand (b) Bundelkhand
(c) Malwa (d) Vidarbha

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (b)

Jejakabhukti was the ancient name of Bundelkhand. This region was named after Jay Shakti or Jeja/Jejak, grandson of Nannuk (founder of Chandel King).

14. Dangdev was the ruler of which dynasty?

(a) Chandelas of Jejakabhukti
(b) Parmar of Malwa
(c) Kalchuri of Mahishmati
(d) Kalchuri of Tripuri

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (a)

Dhangadev, also known as Dhanga, was a king of the Chandel dynasty of Jejakhbukti. He built the Kandariya Mahadev temple. Dhanga attained Moksha by abandoning his body in the waters of Ganga and Yamuna at Sangam, Prayagraj.

15. Arrange the names of the following rulers in correct chronological order and select the correct answer from the codes given below:

1. Vidyadhara 2. Dhanga
3. Yashoverma 4. Keertiverma

Codes :

- (a) 3, 2, 1, 4 (b) 1, 3, 2, 4
(c) 3, 1, 4, 2 (d) 2, 3, 1, 4

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (a)

The correct chronological order of these rulers is Yashovarman (925-950 AD), Dhanga (950-1002 AD), Vidyadhara (1017/19-1029 AD) and Keertivarman (1060-1100 AD).

16. Who among the following built "Tribhuvan Narayan Temple" of Chittour?

- (a) Rana Pratap (b) Raja Dhang
(c) Parmar Raja Bhoj (d) Prithviraj Chauhan

[M.P.P.C.S. (Pre)-2019]

Ans. (c)

The Samidheshwar temple was built by Paramara Raja Bhoj of Malwa. This temple is also known as the Tribhuvan Narayan temple and Bhoj Jagti. Three face idol of Lord Shiva is placed inside temple, which is very similar to the main idol of Lord Shiva of Elephanta cave of Mumbai.

17. Pundravardhan Bhukti was located in:

- (a) North Bengal (b) Bihar
(c) Odisha (d) Assam

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (a)

Pundravardhan Bhukti was located in the region of North Bengal in ancient times. Its territory was expanded to northern Bihar during the era of Pala, Chandra and Sena dynasties.

18. Who was the founder of Pala dynasty?

- (a) Dharmapala (b) Deopala
(c) Gopala (d) Ramapala

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (c)

According to Tibetan historian Lama Taranath, Gopala, the founder of the Pala dynasty, was born near 'Pundravardhana' and was elected the king of Bengal.

19. In which among the following state 'Odantipur' Education Centre was situated?

- (a) Bengal
(b) Bihar

- (c) Gujarat
(d) Tamilnadu
(e) None of the above/more than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre)-2016

Ans. (b)

Odantapuri that was also known as Udnapur, was a prominent education centre during ancient period. It was situated in Bihar and was established by Pala ruler Gopala.

20. Who among the following had built the Sompura Mahavihar?

- (a) Kumaragupta-I (b) Harsha
(c) Dharmapala (d) Vijayasena

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (c)

Dharmapala was an enthusiastic Buddhist. He was called "Param Saugat" in his inscriptions. He constructed famous Buddhist monasteries at Vikramshila and Somapuri (Paharpur). Renowned Buddhist commentator, Haribhadra was also a part of his court. According to Taranath, Dharmapala founded 50 religious schools, but he had no religious intolerance and bigotry as a king.

21. Which ruler of Bengal founded the ancient University called 'Vikramshila.'

- (a) Dharmapala (b) Gopala
(c) Devpala (d) Mahipala

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

43rd B. P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 1994

Ans. (a)

King Dharmapala (770-810 A.D.) of Bengal established the Vikramshila University. After the downfall of Nalanda University, Vikramshila University was developed as the main centre for the Buddhist religion.

22. The Vikramshila University was established by

- (a) Gopala
(b) Dharmapala
(c) Devapala
(d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

King Dharmapala of Pala dynasty established the Vikramshila University. After Nalanda University degraded, it became the main center of Buddhist studies.

23. Who founded the Vikramshila University ?

- (a) Dharmapala (b) Devpala
(c) Rampala (d) Gopal

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

43rd B. P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.

24. Who founded the Vikramshila University?

- (a) Kumarila Bhatta (b) Madhvacharya
(c) Dharmapala (d) Pulakeshin II

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

25. Vikramshila Maha Vihar was established by the ruler of

- (a) Pushyabhuti Dynasty (b) Varman Dynasty
(c) Sen Dynasty (d) Pala Dynasty

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

26. Which one of the following rulers established Vikramashila University?

- (a) Gopal (b) Devapal
(c) Mahipala I (d) Dharmapal

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. 2017

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

27. Vikramshila Mahavihara, a great center of education in ancient India, was established by

- (a) Kumar Gupta-I (b) Harsha
(c) Dharmapala (d) Lakshmanasen

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2002

U.P. Lower (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

28. Who among the following was the founder of Vikramshila University?

- (a) Gopala (b) Dharmapala
(c) Devapala (d) Mahipala

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

29. In which modern-day's State, the University of Vikramasila was located?

- (a) Madhya Pradesh (b) Odisha
(c) Bihar (d) Jharkhand

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

Vikramshila University was established by Pala ruler Dharmapala (770-810 AD) at Bhagalpur in Bihar. Vikramshila's curriculum taught formalized Vedic learning, including Vedic texts, rituals and the Vedangas, such as reasoning, medicine, law, astronomy and city planning.

30. Consider the following statements regarding the Vikramshila University in Bihar :

1. It was located in the present-day Banka district of Bihar.
2. It was established by King Gopala I of the Pala dynasty.
3. The 'Vajrayana' sect of Buddhism flourished here.
4. Other subjects like Astronomy, Logic, Law, Grammar and Philosophy were also taught here.

Which of the above statements are incorrect?

- (a) 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 4
(c) 1 and 2 (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Vikramshila University is located in Bhagalpur and not in Banka district. It was established by Dharmapala of Pala dynasty and not by Gopala I. Hence statements 1 and 2 are incorrect. Rest are correct.

31. Which of the following king/kings was/were elected/ chosen directly by the public?

- (1) Harshavardhan
(2) Gopal
(3) Yashovarman
(4) Nandivarman Pallavamalla

Select the correct answer using the code given below—
Code -

- (a) Only (1), (2) and (4) (b) Only (2), (3) and (4)
(c) Only (2) and (4) (d) Only (2) and (3)

[U.P.R.O./A.R.O (Pre)-2021]

Ans. (c)

The founder of Pala dynasty 'Gopal' and Pallava ruler 'Nandivarman Pallavamalla' were elected/chosen directly by the public. Khalimpur inscription of Dharmapala describes the election of Gopala by people to overcome Matsya Nayaya (Law of the Jungle). After the unexpected death of Pallava ruler Permashwar Varman, people elected Nandivarman Pallavamalla as their king.

32. Which one of the following places was not the center of learning during early medieval period?

- (a) Nalanda (b) Vikramshila
(c) Taxila (d) Uddantapur

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

Takshashila (Taxila) was an early Buddhist center of learning. Taxila was the capital of Gandhara State located in present-day Rawalpindi district of Pakistan. Chanakya (Kautilya), the Maurya emperor Chandragupta, the Ayurvedic healer Charaka and Jivaka studied at Takshashila.

The Vedas and the eighteen arts, which included skills such as archery and elephant lore, were taught. Nalanda University was established in 5th century A.D. by Kumar Gupta. At the beginning of the 12th century, the Muslim invader Bakhtiyar Khalji sacked the university. Dharmapala established Vikramshila University (770-810 A.D.) in Bhagalpur, Bihar. University in Odantapuri was established during the rule of Pala dynasty.

33. Who among the following laid the foundation of Rashtrakuta Empire?

- (a) Amoghavarsha- I (b) Danti Durga
(c) Dhruva (d) Krishna- I

I.A.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (b)

In 736 AD, Danti Durga laid the foundation of the Rashtrakuta Empire. His capital was Manyakheta. It is said that Danti Durga had performed Hiranygarbha oblation in Ujjayini.

34. Who out of the following performed a ritual called 'Hiranya-Garbha'?

- (a) Mayur Sharman (b) Hari Chandra
(c) Danti Durga (d) Harsha

U.P.P.C.S. (Re. Exam) (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

35. Who among the following was born in a military camp in the course of his father's campaign?

- (a) Amoghavarsha Rashtrakuta
(b) Bhoja Parmara
(c) Dharmapala
(d) Nagabhata-II Pratihara

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (a)

Rashtrakuta king Amoghavarsha - I was born in 800 AD in Shriabhavan near Narmada river in a military camp when his father Govind - III was returning after successful campaigns of North India.

36. The greatest Pratihara King was –

- (a) Dharmapala (b) Harsha
(c) Mihir Bhoj (d) Mahendrapala

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (c)

The greatest Pratihara king was Mihir Bhoj (836-885 A.D.). Dharmapala was a prominent king of Pala dynasty (770-810 A.D.). Mahendrapala-I (885-910 A.D.) was Pratihara monarch while Harsha Vardhana was king of Pushyabhuti dynasty (606-647 A.D.).

37. 'Aadi Varaha' was the title of which Gurjar Pratihara ruler?

- (a) Vatsraja (b) Nagbhata II
(c) Mihir Bhoja (d) Nagbhata I

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

Mihir Bhoja-I was the most powerful ruler among the Gurjara-Pratiharas. He was a follower of Vaishnavism. He attained the titles of 'Aadi Varaha' and 'Prabhas'.

38. What is/are not true about King Mihir Bhoja?

- (i) He was the son of Nagabhata-II
(ii) Kannauj was the capital of his kingdom.
(iii) Arab traveller Al-Masudi gave him name of King Baura.

- (a) (i) and (ii) (b) Only (i)
(c) (ii) and (iii) (d) Only (iii)

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Emperor Ramabhadra and queen Appa Devi gave birth to the renowned ruler Raja Mihir Bhoj, who is considered one of the greatest monarchs in history. Mihir Bhoj reconstructed the Pratihara empire, seized control of Kannauj around 836 AD and established it as the capital. Al-Masudi a native of Baghdad, who visited Gujarat in Tenth century A.D., testifies to the great power and prestige of the Pratihara rulers and the vastness of their empire. He calls the Gurjara-Pratihara kingdom Al-Juzr and the king Baura, probably a mispronunciation of Adivaraha, the title used for Bhoja. Although Bhoja had died by that time.

39. Arrange the names of the following historical personalities in correct chronological order and select the correct answer from the codes given below:

1. Nagabhata II 2. Mahipala
3. Mahendrapala 4. Vatsaraja

Codes :

- (a) 2, 3, 1, 4 (b) 4, 1, 3, 2
(c) 1, 2, 3, 4 (d) 3, 1, 4, 2

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (b)

The correct chronological order of these historical personalities is - Vatsaraja (775-800 AD), Nagabhata II (800-833 AD), Mahendrapala I (885-910 AD), and Mahipala (912-944 AD).

40. Which of the following rulers does not belong to Gurjara- Pratihara dynasty?

- (a) Nagabhata-II (b) Mahendrapala-I
(c) Devapala (d) Bharatrabhatta-I

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

The Gurjara-Pratihara dynasty, also known as the Pratihara dynasty was an imperial power during the last classical period on the Indian sub-continent, that ruled much of northern India from mid 8th to 11th century. They ruled first at Ujjain and later at Kannauj. The rulers of this dynasty were as follows - Nagabhatta I (730-756 A.D.), Vatsaraja (775-800 A.D.), Nagabhatta II (800-833 A.D.), Mihir Bhoja-I (836-885 A.D.), Mahendrapala I (885-910 A.D.), Devapala (948-949 A.D.), etc.

41. The Arab traveller Suleman visited India in the reign of Pratihara King –

- (a) Nagbhatta II (b) Nagbhatta I
(c) Vatsraja (d) Bhoja I
(e) Question not attempted

Raj. P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (d)

Mihir Bhoja, also known as Bhoja I, was a Gurjara-Pratihara Dynasty king. The Arab traveller Suleman visited during his reign.

42. The great Jain scholar Hemchandra adorned the court of :

- (a) Amoghavarsha (b) Kumarapala
(c) Jaysimha Siddharaja (d) Vidhyadhara

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

An eminent Jain scholar Hemchandra got fame during the period of Solanki king Jaysimha Siddharaja. However, he adorned the court of his successor Kumarapala (1143-1172 A.D.) as an advisor.

43. Who among the following is credited with initiating a new Samvat :

- (a) Dharmapala (b) Devapala
(c) Vijayasena (d) Lakshmanasena

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (d)

Lakshmanasena (1178 - 1206 A.D.) was the king of Sena Dynasty; reigned 28 years. He initiated a new Samvat called 'Lakshmana Samvat'.

44. The Luxman Era was started by which of the following dynasties ?

- (a) Pratihara (b) Pala
(c) Chauhan (d) Sena

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2005

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

45. Who among the following were famous jurists of medieval India?

1. Vigyaneshvara 2. Hemadri
3. Rajashekhar 4. Jimutavahana

Code :

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2, 3 and 4

(c) 1, 2 and 4

(d) 1 and 4

**I.A.S. (Pre) 1995
U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995**

Ans. (c)

The famous jurists of early medieval India were Hemadri, Vigyaneshvara and Jimutavahana. Vigyaneshvara wrote "Mitakshara" and Jimutavahana wrote "Dayabhaga." Rajashekhar was a court scholar of Gurjara-Pratihara king Mahendrapala - I and his son Mahipala-I. He compiled texts like Karpuramanjari, Kavyamimamsa, Viddhasalabhanjika, Bal Ramayana, Bhuvankosh, etc.

46. Arrange the following Sena rulers of Bengal in ascending chronological order:

1. Ballal Sena
2. Lakshmana Sena
3. Hemanta Sena
4. Vijay Sena

Choose the correct answer from the options given below:

- (a) 4, 3, 2, 1 (b) 2, 1, 4, 3
(c) 1, 2, 3, 4 (d) 3, 4, 1, 2

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (d)

The Sena kings succeeded one another from father to son. The names and order of succession are established by inscriptions as being 1) Samantasena, 2) Hemantasena, 3) Vijayasena, 4) Vallalasena or Ballal Sena, 5) Lakshmanasena and 6) Visvarupasena

47. The great Sanskrit poet and dramatist Rajashekhar was in the court of:

- (a) Raja Bhoj (b) Mahipal
(c) Mahendrapala-I (d) Indra-III

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2013

Ans. (b&c)

Rajashekhar was a court scholar of Gurjara-Pratihara king Mahendrapala - I and his son Mahipala-I. He compiled texts like Karpuramanjari, Kavyamimamsa, Viddhasalabhanjika, Bal Ramayana, Bhuvankosh, etc.

48. Which of the following books was not written by Rajasekhara?

- (a) Kavyamimamsa (b) Karpuramanjari
(c) Prabandhachintamani (d) Viddhasalabhanjika

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2025

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

49. Match List- 1 (Dynasty) with List- 2 (Capital) on the basis of codes :

- | | |
|----------------|---------------|
| List- 1 | List 2 |
| A. Pratihara | 1. Tanjore |
| B. Chola | 2. Anhilwada |

C. Paramara**D. Solanki**

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	4	2	3	1
(b)	4	3	2	1
(c)	4	2	1	3
(d)	4	1	3	2

3. Dhara**4. Kannauj****Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2008****Ans. (d)**

Nagabhata-I is considered as the founder of Pratihara dynasty, but the actual founder of this dynasty was Vatsaraja. Mihir Bhoja was the most prominent ruler of Pratihara Dynasty. The capital of Pratiharas was Kannauj. Vijayalaya established the Chola Empire in 9th century A.D. Tanjore (Tanjavur) was the capital of Cholas. The real founder of Paramara dynasty was Siyak - II and the capital of Paramaras was Dhara. Chalukyas were Agni Clan lineage, founded by Mularaja - I. The capital of Solankis was Anhilwada.

50. Consider the following pairs :

King		Dynasty
1. Nannuka	–	Chandela
2. Jayashakti	–	Paramara
3. Nagabhata II	–	Gurjara Pratihara
4. Bhoja	–	Rashtrakuta

How many pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) Only one pair (b) Only two pairs
(c) Only three pairs (d) All four pairs

I.A.S. (Pre) 2022**Ans. (b)**

In the given options, Nannuka was founder of Chandela dynasty. Jayashakti was also ruler of Chandela dynasty. Nagabhata II was a ruler of Gurjara-Pratihara and Bhoja was a Parmar ruler.

51. The Gurjar-Pratihara dynasty was founded by :

- (a) Nagabhata I (b) Vatsaraja
(c) Harshvardhana (d) Mihir Bhoja

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2003**U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2002****Ans. (a)**

Pratihara dynasty was the most famous dynasty of Rajputs of 'Agni' clan. It is also known as Gurjara-Pratihara Dynasty because of its link with Gurjars. Gurjars were first mentioned in the Aihole inscription of Pulakesin - II, as well as in Harshacharita of Banabhatta. Nagabhata - I (730-756 AD) was the founder of this dynasty. He destroyed the army of Maleksha ruler, and thus, he also saved western India from the Arab's invasion. It's mentioned in Gwalior inscription.

52. Which were the three dynasties that were engaged in a tripartite struggle for Kannauj?

1. Chola
2. Pala
3. Gurjara

4. Rashtrakuta**Choose the correct answer from the codes given below :**

- (a) 1, 2, 3 (b) 1, 2, 4
(c) 2, 3, 4 (d) 1, 3, 4

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2002**Ans. (c)**

After the death of Harsha, Kannauj was the center of attraction for various powerful dynasties. It was compared with Magadha during the Gupta period. In order to control the territory, Pala, Gurjara-Pratihara and Rashtrakuta started a tripartite struggle, which has been described as a most important event in the history of North India during the 8-9th century A.D. Finally, Pratiharas came out as the winner.

53. Who among the following was not a part of the tripartite struggle?

- (a) Pratiharas (b) Palas
(c) Rashtrakutas (d) Cholas

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015**Ans. (d)**

See the explanation of above question.

54. Mahodaya is an old name of –

- (a) Allahabad (b) Khajuraho
(c) Kannauj (d) Patna

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012**Ans. (c)**

Mahodaya is an old name of Kannauj.

55. Which of the following was known as 'Nagar Mahodaya Shri'?

- (a) Mahoba (b) Kampilya
(c) Mathura (d) Kannauj

U.P. Lower Sub. (Mains) 2015**Ans. (d)**

Kannauj is an ancient city whose ancient name was Mahodaya Shri and Mahodaya during the regime of Mihir Bhoja.

56. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

Early Medieval Cities of Uttar Pradesh)	(Present Status)
---	------------------

- | | |
|--------------------|-------------|
| (a) Koil | – Aligarh |
| (b) Mahotsav Nagar | – Mahoba |
| (c) Mahodaya Shree | – Kannauj |
| (d) Jaijakhbukti | – Kaushambi |

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre)-2021**Ans. (d)**

Correct match is as follows–

Early Medieval Cities of Uttar Pradesh	Present Status
Koil	– Aligarh
Mahotsav Nagar	– Mahoba
Mahodaya Shri	– Kannauj
Jejakabhukti	– Bundelkhand

57. Which among the following Rashtrakuta Kings defeated Pratihara ruler Nagabhata-II?

- (a) Dhruva (b) Govind-III
(c) Indra-III (d) Krishna-III

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

Govind-III was the successor of Rashtrakuta king Dhruva. After consolidating his position in South India, he attacked North India. During his North India campaign, he attacked Gurjara-Pratihara ruler Nagabhata-II and defeated him. Sanjan and Radhanpur copper plate inscriptions mention his victory.

58. Who among the following granted financial aid for the restoration of a demolished mosque in Khambhat :

- (a) Chamundaraya (b) Jayasimha Siddharaja
(c) Kumarapala (d) Mahipaladeva

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1999

Ans. (b)

Chalukya king Jayasimha Siddharaja was a tolerant religious king. Muslim author Muhammad Auji wrote that he granted financial aid of 1 lakh Balom (currency) for the restoration of a demolished mosque in Khambhat.

59. Who was the founder of Parmara Dynasty?

- (a) Ajai Pal (b) Kanak Pal
(c) Kanak Rao (d) Jagat Pal

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (*)

Parmara dynasty was founded in 9th century AD by a person named Upendra or Krishnaraj. City named Dhara was the capital of Parmara dynasty. The commission has accepted option (b) Kanakpala as the answer whereas the correct answer is Upendra or Krishnaraj.

60. King Bhoja ruled over –

- (a) Bastar (b) Dhara
(c) Mahakaushal (d) Ujjain

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

King Bhoj was a Parmara ruler. The early capital of Parmaras was Ujjain. Later, the capital was transferred to Dhara. After the death of King Bhoj, scholars said – “Adya Dhara NiraDhara, Niralamba Saraswati, Pandita Khandita Sarve Bhoj Raje Divangate”.

61. Who amongst the following wrote a book on artificial scientific equipment?

- (a) Bhoja (b) Govindraja
(c) Chandravermana (d) Mahipala

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

The popular book ‘Samarangana Sutradhara’ written by Parmara king Bhoj was based on artificial scientific equipment. ‘Saraswati Kanthabharan’, ‘Siddhanta Sangraha’, ‘YogaSutraVritti’, ‘Rajamartand’, ‘Yukti Kalpataru’ and ‘Karucharya’ are some of his masterpieces. In the beginning, the commission considered option (a) as the correct answer, but in its revised answer sheet, the commission has changed the answer to option (b).

62. The presiding deity of Bhojshala Temple is:-

- (a) Goddess Durga (b) Goddess Parvati
(c) Goddess Lakshmi (d) Goddess Saraswati

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

Bhojshala temple is located in the Dhar district of Madhya Pradesh and was established by Parmara King Bhoj in 1035 A.D. as a Sanskrit school. The presiding deity of Bhojshala temple is Goddess Saraswati. Now Bhojshala temple is situated in premises of Kamal Maula Mosque.

63. Who among the following was not a king of the Parmar dynasty?

- (a) Upendra (b) Munj
(c) Gangeyadev (d) Udayaditya

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

Gangeyadev was a ruler of the Kalachuri dynasty. He adopted the title of Vikramaditya. He started issuing gold coins after its extinction in pre-medieval period. Upendra, Munj and Udayaditya were rulers of Parmara dynasty.

64. Who among the following Arab writers has given the description of Kalachuri ruler Gangeyadeva and his capital Tripuri?

- (a) Al-Bahari (b) Al-Masudi
(c) Al-Biruni (d) Ibn Battuta

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

The Arab writer and geographer Al-Biruni is known for providing a description of the Kalachuri ruler Gangeyadeva and his capital Tripuri. Al-Biruni was a Khwarazmian Iranian scholar and polymath during the Islamic Golden Age. He wrote a treatise on Indian culture titled Tarikh al-Hind.

65. Consider the following pairs:

Famous places	Regions
1. Bodhgaya	: Baghelkhand
2. Khajuraho	: Bundelkhand
3. Shirdi	: Vidarbha
4. Nasik (Nashik)	: Malwa
5. Tirupati	: Rayalaseema

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

- (a) 1, 2 and 4 (b) 2, 3, 4 and 5
(c) 2 and 5 only (d) 1, 3, 4 and 5

Ans. (c)

The correctly matched places with their regions are as follows:

Famous place		Region/ State
Bodhgaya	-	Bihar
Khajuraho	-	Bundelkhand
Shirdi	-	Maharashtra
Nasik (Nashik)	-	Maharashtra
Tirupati	-	Royalaseema

Thus, the correctly matched pairs in the given options are options (2) and (5).

66. The author of Gaudavaho was –

- (a) Harishena (b) Aryabhatta
(c) Vakpati (d) Banabhatta

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (c)

"Gaudavaho" was authored by Vakpati, who was a court poet of the king of Kannauj, Yashovarman.

67. With reference to the economic history of medieval India, the term 'Araghatta' refers to –

- (a) Bonded labour
(b) Land grants made to military officers
(c) Waterwheel used for the irrigation of land
(d) Wasteland converted to cultivated land

I.A.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

Araghatta is a Persian wheel, which, is a mechanical water lifting device usually operated by animals like bullocks, buffaloes or camels, used in the irrigation of land. It is mentioned in the Panchatantra and Rajtarangini.

68. Which Sultan was reputed to be 'Akbar of Kashmir'?

- (a) Sultan Shamsuddin Shah
(b) Sultan Qutubuddin
(c) Sultan Sikandar
(d) Sultan Zainul Abidin
(e) None of the above/more than one of the above

[64th B.P.S.C.(Pre)-2018]

Ans. (d)

In 1420 A.D. brother of Ali Shah, Shahi Khan, sat on the throne of Kashmir with the name of Zain-ul-Abidin. He was greatest ruler of Kashmir who ruled for nearly 50 years. On account of his liberal religious policy, promotion of learning, and interest in art and architecture he was called 'Akbar of Kashmir'.

69. What was the original name of ruler of Kashmir Zain-ul-Abidin?

- (a) Ali Shah (b) Hasan Shah
(c) Haider Shah (d) Shahi Khan

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

70. Who was the founder of Karnata dynasty?

- (a) Nanyadev
(b) Narshimhadev
(c) Vijaydev
(d) Haridev
(e) None of the above/more than one of the above

[60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre)-2016]

Ans. (a)

The founder of Karnata dynasty was Nanyadev (1097-1147 AD). He was a great warrior. He established his capital in Simraungadh and ruled Mithila region.

71. Who was the last king of Karnata dynasty?

- (a) Harisimha
(b) Ramsimha
(c) Matisimha
(d) Shyamsimha
(e) None of the above/more than one of the above

[60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre)-2016]

Ans. (a)

Harisimha (1295/1296-1324 AD) was the last ruler of Karnata dynasty. He was a great protector of art and literature. He started the Panji system.

72. Information about which king is found in the 'Kuruspal Inscription'?

- (a) Harsha Gupta
(b) Mahapraraj
(c) Someshwar I
(d) Mahashivgupta Balarjun

[Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre)-2020]

Ans. (c)

Kuruspal village is located in Bastar district in Chhattisgarh. A number of inscriptions have been found here.

- Kuruspal stone inscription of Someswardeva : It is much mutilated. It records the grant by king Someswardeva of Nagavamsa of a village whose name cannot be made out.
➤ Kuruspal Tank slab of Dharana Mahadevi : The inscription, which is built in one of the steps of a tank in Kuruspal, records the grant of land situated near Kalamba village to god Kamesvara (Shiva) by the queen Dharna Mahadevi during the reign of king Someswardeva/Someshwar I.